STATE SCAN

KERALA: SAFFRON COATING RUNS THIN *PG 18*

J&K: THE TOLL OF NEGLIGENCE *PG 20*



VOTER OUTREACH SP chief Akhilesh Yadav addresses a press conference in Lucknow, Nov. 12

SUMIT KUMAR

UTTAR PRADESH

SOUND OF SIRENS

Parties go into battle mode on the ground as electoral roll revision kicks off

By **Avaneesh Mishra**

IT'S NOT EVEN SLOW BURN. UTTAR PRADESH VOTES for a new assembly only in 2027, but the month-long Special Intensive Revision (SIR) has already turned it into a live battleground. Rolled out on November 4, it has put the entire field on high flame. Every party is moving to fortify its position: war rooms are being formed, party websites and WhatsApp groups being readied to track deletions, minders being named to keep a hawk's eye. It's being fought, well, booth and nail.

Supplying electricity to this political grid is the landslide win for the National Democratic Alliance (NDA) next door in Bihar, preceded by the SIR's controversial rollout. In UP, the Samajwadi Party (SP) has taken the most confrontational stance. Akhilesh Yadav calls Bihar a cautionary tale, framing it as a battle for voter protection. In posts on X, he named a new layer of party oversight: 'PDA Praharis', or patrol squads for its Backward-Dalit-Minorities vote base, who will form a 'PPTV', following the revision teams "like a shadow", flagging anything suspicious. "The game played by